

FACIAL FRACTURES

PATIENT & FAMILY INFORMATION

Health New Zealand
Te Whatu Ora

TRAUMA SERVICE

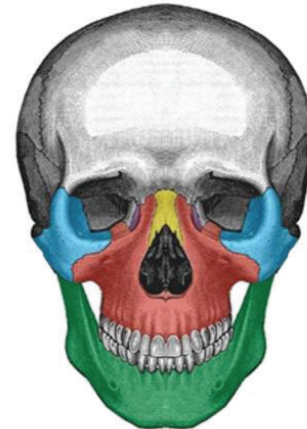
Capital, Coast and Hutt Valley

WHAT ARE FACIAL FRACTURES?

Facial fractures are broken bones in the face or mouth. These may include:

- Nose (nasal bones)
- Cheekbones (zygoma)
- Bones around the eyes (orbits including lacrimal)
- Upper jaw (maxilla)
- Lower jaw (mandible)

Because you have facial fractures, the surgical team has recommended Sinus Precautions. These are important to protect your healing bones and prevent complications.



■	Zygomatic
■	Maxilla
■	Nasal
■	Lacrimal
■	Mandible

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GENERAL CARE INSTRUCTIONS

- Sleep with your head raised:
 - keep your head slightly elevated, even while sleeping
 - do not lie flat. This helps reduce swelling
- Have a soft diet.

FOR THE NEXT 6 WEEKS

Avoid actions that increase pressure inside your face and sinuses:

- Do not use a straw to drink
- Avoid very hot drinks. Let them cool down first
 - numb areas can burn easily
- Do not blow your nose or sniff, even if it's blocked
- Use moist gauze to gently clean any crusting around your nose
- Don't hold in a sneeze. Sneeze with your mouth open to reduce pressure
- Avoid bending over. Keep your head higher than your heart
- Do not lift or push heavy objects.

MOUTH & DENTAL CARE

- Help your mouth stay clean and prevent infection:
 - rinse with salt water or Chlorhexidine mouthwash 3 times a day or after eating (if advised)
 - brush your teeth gently.
- Do not smoke — it slows healing.

ACTIVITIES TO AVOID

These activities can create pressure and interfere with healing:

- Flying
- Scuba diving or sky diving
- Swimming
- Blowing up balloons or similar activities.

WHEN TO SEEK MEDICAL HELP

Get urgent medical attention if you experience:

- Worsening pain
- Fever or redness around your wound
- Vision changes
- Vomiting or unusual drowsiness
- Trouble breathing or swallowing
- Any other symptoms that concern you.

HEALTHLINE

If you can't access a GP or you don't have one, or if you are concerned and want advice from a health professional, call:
Healthline free on **0800 611 116**

CONTACT US

Department: Trauma Service CCHV

Phone: 027 801 9625 or 021 190 2845

Email: TRAUMASERVICE@ccdhb.org.nz

Hours: 7am-4pm, Monday to Friday